

Audience Sensitivity, Content Compliance & Format Preference Analysis

France Top 50 Spotify Playlist

Prepared for: Atlantic Recording Corporation
Platform: Unified Mentor Internship Program
Dataset: France Top 50 Spotify Playlist
Period: May 2024 – November 2025
Records: 27,800 entries | 555 days

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This research paper presents a comprehensive analysis of the France Top 50 Spotify playlist for Atlantic Recording Corporation (ARC), covering 27,800 daily chart entries across 555 days (May 2024 – November 2025). The study examines four critical dimensions: explicit content sensitivity, release format preference, album structural impact, and song duration alignment. Key findings reveal that while explicit content comprises 56.3% of chart entries, clean tracks command a statistically significant popularity premium of +10.4 points (80.9 vs 73.3). Singles outperform albums by 10.6 popularity points, album dilution is confirmed for releases exceeding 15 tracks, and the optimal song duration aligns with the 2.5–4 minute window. The paper concludes with six data-driven strategic recommendations for ARC's France market content strategy.

Keywords:
playlist a

1. INTRODUCTION

The French music market operates under a distinct cultural framework characterised by strong emphasis on lyrical appropriateness, greater scrutiny of explicit content, and historically deep engagement with artist catalogues over rapid single releases. For Atlantic Recording Corporation, understanding content compliance and format acceptance in France is essential for informed release decisions, explicit-content risk management, and culturally aligned playlist pitching strategies.

This study analyses the France Top 50 Spotify playlist — a daily snapshot of the 50 most-streamed tracks in France — providing ARC with actionable intelligence across four analytical domains. The dataset spans 555 consecutive days from May 2024 to November 2025, yielding 27,800 track-day observations.

1.1 Research Objectives

- Quantify the prevalence and popularity impact of explicit versus clean content in French charts.
- Determine whether French audiences prefer singles or album tracks, and at what popularity premium.
- Assess the relationship between album size (track count) and individual track performance.
- Identify the optimal song duration range for France chart performance.
- Derive strategic content recommendations for Atlantic Recording Corporation.

1.2 Significance

Without this insight, content strategies risk misalignment with French audience expectations, leading to suboptimal playlist placements, missed compliance requirements, and reduced streaming performance. This analysis bridges the gap between raw streaming data and actionable A&R; strategy.

2. DATASET & METHODOLOGY

2.1 Dataset Description

The dataset `Atlantic_France.csv` was sourced from Atlantic Recording Corporation's Spotify monitoring system, capturing daily snapshots of the France Top 50 playlist. Each row represents a single track's appearance on a given date.

Field	Type	Description
date	Date	Date of playlist snapshot (dd-mm-yyyy)
position	Integer	Chart rank (1–50)

song	String	Song title
artist	String	Artist name(s)
popularity	Integer	Spotify popularity score (0–100)
duration_ms	Integer	Track duration in milliseconds
album_type	String	Release type: single or album
total_tracks	Integer	Number of tracks in the release
is_explicit	Boolean	Explicit content flag (TRUE/FALSE)
album_cover_url	String	Album artwork URL

Table 1: Dataset field descriptions.

2.2 Data Preparation

- Date parsing: Converted dd-mm-yyyy strings to datetime objects; validated 50 entries per day.
- Duration conversion: Transformed duration_ms to duration_min (divided by 60,000).
- Explicit normalisation: Standardised is_explicit to boolean (TRUE/FALSE).
- Duration bucketing: Short (<2.5 min), Medium (2.5–4 min), Long (>4 min).
- Album size classification: Small (≤15 tracks) vs Large (>15 tracks).
- Rank tier creation: Top 10, Top 11–25, Top 26–50.

2.3 Analytical Methodology

#	Module	Analysis Performed
1	Data Validation & Preparation	Data integrity checks; derived field engineering
2	Explicit Content Sensitivity	Explicit vs clean prevalence, popularity delta, rank-tier distribution
3	Release Format Preference	Single vs album distribution, popularity comparison, rank analysis
4	Album Structure Impact	Track count distribution, album size vs popularity, dilution effect
5	Song Duration Preference	Duration distribution, bucket analysis, popularity-duration correlation
6	Content Attribute Concentration	Attribute density across Top 10 / Top 25 / Top 50

Table 2: Analytical methodology overview.

3. FINDINGS

3.0 Key Performance Indicators Summary

56.3% Explicit Content Share	80.9 Clean Track Avg Pop	47.1% Single Format Share	3.09m Avg Song Duration	74.5 Small Album Avg Pop	62.4% Explicit in Top 10
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3.1 Explicit Content Sensitivity Analysis

Of the 27,800 chart entries analysed, 15,640 (56.3%) were flagged as explicit and 12,160 (43.7%) as clean. Despite explicit content's plurality, clean tracks demonstrated consistently higher Spotify popularity scores across all rank tiers, representing a 10.4% performance premium.

Content Type	Entries	Share	Avg Popularity	vs Baseline
Explicit	15,640	56.3%	73.33	—
Clean	12,160	43.7%	80.90	+10.4% premium

Table 3: Explicit vs clean content performance comparison.

Rank Tier	Explicit (%)	Clean (%)	Total Entries
Top 10	62.4%	37.6%	5,560
Top 11–25	54.5%	45.5%	8,340
Top 26–50	54.8%	45.2%	13,900

Table 4: Explicit content share by rank tier.

The format-level breakdown is instructive: album tracks are explicit 72.4% of the time versus only 38.2% for singles. This represents a compounding compliance risk for album-format releases in France.

3.2 Release Format Preference Analysis

Singles achieved an average popularity score of 80.75 versus 72.99 for album tracks — a differential of 10.6 points (14.5% premium). Singles also carry a significantly lower explicit rate (38.2% vs 72.4%), making them both more compliant and more popular for the French market.

Format	Entries	Share	Avg Popularity	Premium vs Album
Single	13,096	47.1%	80.75	+10.6 pts (+14.5%)
Album	14,695	52.9%	72.99	Baseline

Table 5: Single vs album format performance comparison.

3.3 Album Structure Impact Analysis

Albums with 15 or fewer tracks averaged a popularity score of 74.48, compared to 70.91 for albums exceeding 15 tracks — a dilution penalty of 3.57 points (–4.8%). Single-track releases (total_tracks = 1) account for 40.8% of all chart entries (11,335 records), confirming the singles-dominant landscape.

Album Size	Avg Popularity	Dilution Effect
Small (≤15 tracks)	74.48	Baseline
Large (>15 tracks)	70.91	–3.57 pts (–4.8%)

Table 6: Album size impact on individual track popularity.

3.4 Song Duration Preference Analysis

The average song duration across all chart entries was 3.09 minutes (median: 3.03 min, SD: 0.67 min). 81.7% of all entries fall within the medium duration bucket (2.5–4 minutes). Popularity scores are nearly uniform across buckets (range: 76.53–77.79), indicating duration is not a primary driver of popularity.

Duration Bucket	Entries	Share	Avg Popularity
Short (<2.5 min)	3,582	12.9%	76.91

Medium (2.5–4 min)	22,717	81.7%	76.53
Long (>4 min)	1,501	5.4%	77.79

Table 7: Song duration bucket analysis.

3.5 Content Attribute Concentration Analysis

Metric	Top 10	Top 11–25	Top 26–50
Explicit Share	62.4%	54.5%	54.8%
Single Format	48.2%	46.8%	46.5%
Avg Popularity	79.1	76.4	74.3
Avg Duration	3.02 min	3.10 min	3.11 min

Table 8: Content attribute concentration by rank tier.

4. ARTIST LANDSCAPE

The chart is heavily dominated by French rap and trap artists. Werenoï leads all artists with 2,206 chart-day appearances — 2.4 times the next closest artist (PLK: 906). The top 10 artists collectively account for approximately 30.4% of all chart entries, highlighting significant catalogue concentration.

Rank	Artist	Chart Appearances	Share of Total
1	Werenoï	2,206	7.9%
2	PLK	906	3.3%
3	SDM	901	3.2%
4	Jul	711	2.6%
5	Ninho	622	2.2%
6	Fave	597	2.1%
7	Tiakola	594	2.1%
8	GIMS	559	2.0%
9	KeBlack	546	2.0%
10	Dua Lipa	489	1.8%

Table 9: Top 10 artists by total chart appearances.

5. STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the findings, the following six data-driven recommendations are presented to Atlantic Recording Corporation for optimising their France market content strategy:

m Reach

Clean singles command the highest popularity score (80.75) and lowest release, clean edits should be the primary version pitched to Spotify editors. This is a meaningful competitive advantage in playlist placement.

egy	Singles outperform albums by 10.6 popularity points and carry significant clean singles ahead of any album drop to build chart presence first.
r	The album dilution effect is empirically confirmed: tracks from large albums outperform smaller albums (-4.8%). France rewards tight, curated releases over sprawling ones.
Releases	With 72.4% of album tracks explicit, ARC faces compounding risk in France. Submit every album track before French market submission to maximise playlist eligibility.
indow	81.7% of chart entries fall within this range. While duration has minimal impact, releases within the 3-4 minute window are statistically under-represented. Avoid extreme outliers for France.
ns for Catalogue Longevity	Werenoï, PLK, SDM, Jul, and Ninho dominate the chart with persistence. Pursue feature and collaboration opportunities with these domestic artists to leverage their cross-audience reach in France.

6. CONCLUSION

This research provides Atlantic Recording Corporation with a comprehensive, data-grounded understanding of the France Top 50 Spotify ecosystem. The analysis of 27,800 daily chart observations across 555 days demonstrates that the French streaming market rewards clean, concise, well-structured releases — particularly clean singles from curated albums of 15 tracks or fewer.

While explicit content maintains a 56.3% plurality and clearly does not prevent tracks from charting, it consistently underperforms clean content on popularity metrics. The dominance of French rap artists in long-term chart presence underscores the importance of local market integration. The six strategic recommendations offer ARC a clear, evidence-based roadmap for France-specific content deployment grounded in 18 months of real streaming behaviour.

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